

Skills

Assessing Radial Pulse

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene. Donned appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) based on the patient's need for isolation precautions or risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed for factors that could affect pulse rate and rhythm. Used gloves when necessary.	☐	☐	☐	
Helped patient into appropriate position.	☐	☐	☐	
If the patient was sitting, bent the elbow 90 degrees and supported the lower arm on the chair or on own arm, slightly extended or flexed the wrist, with the palm down.	☐	☐	☐	
Placed fingers properly on patient's inner wrist, extended or flexed wrist until strongest pulse was felt.	☐	☐	☐	
Pressed against radius until pulse was obliterated, relaxed pressure until pulse was palpable.	☐	☐	☐	
Rated strength of pulse properly.	☐	☐	☐	
Noted regularity and rate of rhythm properly.	☐	☐	☐	

Helped patient to comfortable position, placed personal items within reach. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed call light within reach, ensured patient knew how to use it. ☐ ☐ ☐

Raised appropriate number of side rails and lowered bed to ensure patient safety. ☐ ☐ ☐

Disposed of used supplies and equipment, left patient's room tidy. ☐ ☐ ☐

Removed and disposed of PPE when worn, performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Discussed finding with patient as needed. ☐ ☐ ☐

Compared patient's pulse rate and character with baseline and acceptable range. ☐ ☐ ☐

Documented and reported patient's response and outcomes. ☐ ☐ ☐

Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____